



MONTHLY UPDATE

Cameroon: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-31 · 49 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Cabinet reviewed the national artificial-intelligence strategy on 30 July and was told it is [still being developed, with ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled](#) — a year after a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars was presented. The same session recorded Cameroon as a [founding member of a global AI cooperation body](#), with no accession date published.

Payments moved regionally rather than nationally: an [interoperable QR-code standard launched at Douala on 29 July](#), and the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system on 9 July](#).

The data-protection authority's position was restated and did not change: [created in law, not established, and carrying no appropriation in the FY2025 or FY2026 estimates](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

An account of 27 July set out where the satellite licence stands: a [draft concession convention and specification finalised by the regulator, the file at the ministry undecided for more than two years, and the 2024 seizure circular still operative](#). The objections on record are lawful interception, armed-group use, and the incumbent's commercial position.

Legislation and regulation

The one legislative act in the window changes the regulator rather than the rules it applies. A finance ministry order [moved the telecoms regulator from the third to the second category of public establishments, on its average realised budget across the 2022, 2023 and 2024 financial years](#). The category governs institutional standing and pay structure, so what moved is the regulator's own position in the state rather than any power it holds over the sector. Neither the order text nor the budget figures behind it are published.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The state set itself a public venue for the question its record does not answer. The posts and telecommunications ministry is [hosting the 2026 national Internet Governance Forum in Yaounde from 18 to 20 August](#), on the theme of moving from fragmentation to interoperability and positioning data as the foundation of interoperable digital public infrastructure, with a plenary on a possible national data-governance strategic framework. The base holds no

government interoperability layer and no data-governance framework, so the plenary's subject is an absence rather than an instrument. What is held is a preview: no programme document, participant list or prior edition, and no outcome.

The 2026 national Internet Governance Forum [met at the Palais des Congres in Yaounde from 18 to 20 August](#) under the theme of moving from fragmentation to interoperability and making data the backbone of public digital services. No resolution, communique or follow-up mechanism came out of it.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

An account of 27 July put the national fibre backbone at [over 15,000 km](#), against about 12,000 km terrestrial on the 2024 reference year; the two figures are not reconciled to a single primary and may rest on different measurement bases.

The same account records the [2024 customs circular on satellite terminals still operative](#), with kits entering through indirect registration abroad and ten modems seized at one post in December 2025.

The regulator's director-general said the [preparatory work for 5G is practically complete but set no date for commercial launch](#), calling for more operator investment. A regulator saying the groundwork is done while naming no date is the whole of the position: no spectrum award, coverage obligation or licence term is on file.

Data Storage

The state operator spent the month selling capacity it has already built. It [showed the Zamengoe data centre to a second prospective tenant on 13 August](#), presenting hosting, storage and security services and the facility's Tier III certification, eight months after the central bank toured the same site with a view to hosting. The base holds no signed hosting contract from either visit.

Cybersecurity

A [fourth loan tranche of FCFA 39.2bn for intelligent urban video surveillance was authorised by decree](#), bringing FCFA 150.8bn mobilised over eight years across three Chinese lenders. The first phase's borrower was the defence ministry, and the two accounts held give different amounts and dates for it. No camera count, coverage area, retention rule or oversight arrangement is published for any tranche.

The month also produced the base's first measure of what cybercrime costs an individual here. A comparative study puts the [average loss per online job scam at 132,000 FCFA for Cameroonian victims, against 58,000 FCFA in Chad](#), and finds 82% of the Cameroonian cases to be WhatsApp-based social engineering linked to Nigerian networks, where the Chadian pattern is more localised SMS and voice phishing. It is a survey of respondents rather than a reported-crime series, and no sample size or national loss total is carried in the record held.

DPI

Data Exchange

On 29 July a joint communiqué [established a trilateral customs steering committee with Nigeria and Benin](#), committing to harmonised procedures, digital interoperability and coordinated risk management on two named corridors, with no timeline, budget or system specification published. At home the layer that would carry any of this acquired an owner rather than a design: at the opening of the national internet governance forum on 18 August the

posts and telecommunications ministry [tasked the state operator CAMTEL with carrying national data and infrastructure interoperability](#), resting the mandate on its backbone, transmission, access and hosting infrastructure. No instrument, timetable or budget accompanies it.

The minister responsible for decentralisation and local development said on 25 August 2026 that the administration [has built digital islands side by side and that these must end](#) – a ministerial commitment rather than a platform. The same problem framed the national Internet Governance Forum in Yaounde a week earlier.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Two identity operations ran in the month, both municipal. On 27 July [4,000 free identity cards were handed over at Yaoundé 5](#), some to recipients blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records, cleared by seconding police officers on site; the operation was timed to public-service and police recruitment competitions, for which the card is a precondition. From 3 July, [compulsory registration of taxi owners and drivers opened on a city platform](#), with a QR code and a unique door number per driver and unregistered taxis barred after 5 October.

The register underneath both is only now being equipped. On 7 August the United Nations development programme [opened a tender for the equipment of three pilot centres digitising civil-status registration](#). Three centres is the whole of the stated scope, and the notice names neither their locations nor a value or timetable – against a paper record the base elsewhere shows being used to draw fraudulent payroll claims.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Payments had the month's densest run. On 9 July the regional central bank [joined the pan-African settlement system, extending it to all six member states and 72m people](#), with member-state banks to be integrated by end-2026; no Cameroonian bank is yet named as live on it. On 29 July an [interoperable QR-code standard launched under a regional regulation of 8 April](#), letting any bank, microfinance or mobile-money application scan any merchant code across the six states. A day later a [consultation opened on revising the switch's tariff grid](#), the operator conceding that current pricing penalises low-value transactions and drives artificial splitting of payments; no revised grid or effective date is published.

The continental rail reached the monetary union without reaching its businesses. The central bank joined the pan-African payment and settlement system on 9 July, which [an analysis of the trade minister's 21 August call to business describes as the necessary monetary and regulatory piece and not one that opens the service to customers: commercial banks, fintechs and payment providers must still connect technically and switch on the channels that initiate transactions](#). The operator's coverage claims - 28 countries, more than 190 banks and fintechs, 16 switches - establish reachability rather than that any institution here can yet send and receive.

A domestic entrant arrived on 31 August. A Cameroonian technology company [launched a payments platform carrying transfers across mobile-money networks, wallet management, bill and airtime payment, payment links and developer interfaces, opening here with a stated ambition to reach other African markets](#). It is a launch announcement on the company's own account: no user, merchant or transaction figure, licence or partner bank is named.

Registries

The [national civil-status registry platform was reported deployed in pilot councils on 16 July](#); the source names no councils and gives no target. The one delivery figure on the record for the wider programme comes from outside government: the national human rights commission, [calling for a modernised and interoperable civil registry on 10 August, put birth-certificate cases processed under a World Bank-backed programme at over 49,000](#).

Sectoral management information systems

Health and education information systems both gained instruments and neither reports a deliverable. A EUR 8m technical-assistance agreement over 36 months covers the education management information system, the basic-education ministry's mapping platform, interconnection of the education databases and dynamic dashboards; the funder is not stated and the signature date is not published. The national digital health strategic plan launched on 4 March with an envelope of about FCFA 29bn across eight axes including governance, legal framework and health-information-system interoperability, and a pandemic preparedness project was launched with no deliverable reported. Collection moved where the plans did not: the health ministry took delivery of nearly 1,000 smartphones on 7 August to run the SCANFORM data-collection system in place of paper forms, across ten regions, 175 health districts and 395 facilities, with over 1,500 health workers to be trained. The counts are the ministry's own and no go-live date is given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The water utility began rolling out a centralised commercial platform, WATERIS, with five days of internal training from 10 August, replacing decentralised commercial management with automated meter reading and more electronic payment channels. The account is the director general's; no customer count, cost or completion date is stated.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The same seminar put council digitisation at 230 councils, about 64% nationally, with 48.6% of North West councils operating functional websites, 335 municipal portals developed and 145 authorities equipped.

Technology

AI

Cabinet was told on 30 July that the national AI strategy is still being developed, with ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled and no adoption instrument published; a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars had been presented in July 2025. The AI authority and presidential council that roadmap provided for remain uncreated and are absent from the ten priorities, which carry only adaptation of the legal framework. Among the priorities is a national high-performance computing centre, announced with no site, cost, operator or timetable. At the same session the telecommunications minister said Cameroon had acceded as a founding member of a global AI cooperation body; the accession date is not published.

The higher-education ministry set out a strategy for artificial intelligence in higher education at the Global Smart Education Conference in Beijing from 18 to 20 August 2026. No strategy document, budget or implementation date has been published behind it.

Innovation ecosystem

A domestically built platform for creating online shops was profiled on 26 August, co-founded by a Cameroonian software engineer and pitched at widening access to digital markets for regional traders. No user, merchant, transaction or revenue figure is published, and the account is a founder profile in a trade outlet rather than a company disclosure.

Capacity

Literacy

A digital financial-literacy project running in Cameroon and Senegal since June 2024 [closed on 15 July](#), leaving a digital financial-services comparison platform with no funded data-update mechanism; it was offered to both states and neither is reported as having accepted. No Cameroon-side trainee count, budget share or partner list is published.

Training and skills

The AI workforce target was carried into the same cabinet review without moving: [60,000 specialists by 2040 including 40% women](#) was set in July 2025, and a year later [AI modules in curricula appear among ten priorities with a roadmap tabled but no adoption, budget line or trainee count](#).

What was delivered was smaller and dated. A first implementation wave under an operator and higher-education memorandum [opened 115 internships across all ten regions on 22 July](#), in disciplines from telecommunications and cybersecurity to finance and law; no stipend, duration or conversion-to-employment figure is published.

Research institutions

Two research builds were tabled in the same cabinet review list — [a sovereign scientific database on a dedicated national platform and a centre for the digitisation of scientific and technical information](#) — with no cost, site or timeline for either.

Data

National statistics

The fourth population and agriculture census is still in the field: a [complementary enumeration period runs from 1 August to 15 September to reach households, persons and agricultural holdings missed by the 29 May close](#). Enumeration ran with [32,059 agents at a budget of FCFA 13.28bn against FCFA 64bn initially projected](#), and no results are published. It is the first census in over twenty years, with population and agriculture merged into one questionnaire.

Open data

A national open-data policy is [provided for in the artificial-intelligence roadmap and nothing is published](#). It was [not among the ten priority areas tabled to cabinet on 30 July](#).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

On 8 July the state operator held a [working session with a global cloud vendor's Africa executives and the United States embassy ICT representative](#). It is talks only: no agreement, investment commitment, timeline, or answer on [where Cameroonian data would sit](#), and it sits against the operator's own sovereign-cloud line and a regional data-residency recommendation.

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